

Incident Investigation Report

Sysmon telemetry and Wazuh alerts — isolated laboratory host
Host DESKTOP-5OG7C28 · Agent Windows_VM (192.168.232.130) · 2 October 2026

1. Executive Summary

Between 14:50:40 and 14:59:42 UTC on 2 October 2026, Wazuh agent Windows_VM (192.168.232.130) forwarded 31 events from DESKTOP-5OG7C28. Six of those became alerts. The relevant cluster is two bursts, about two minutes apart, under interactive user DESKTOP-5OG7C28\Darragh Casey at high integrity, logon 0xA8D6D, session 1, parent PID 4408 (parent image not captured).

Observed in that cluster:

- Five hostname.exe and three whoami.exe process creates, current directory C:\Users\Darragh Casey\Desktop\T1059.003\.
- PowerShell Test-Path checks for C:\AtomicRedTeam\atomics\..\ExternalPayloads\T1059.003_script.bat, which resolves to C:\AtomicRedTeam\ExternalPayloads\T1059.003_script.bat.
- PowerShell Start-Process of that batch file, which spawned cmd.exe /c against the same path (Sysmon event record 15251; Wazuh rule 92004).
- Three file-create events for __PSScriptPolicyTest_*.ps1 under the user Temp folder, raised as level-15 rule 92213 and tagged T1105. The filenames and creating process are PowerShell’s own script-policy test files, not a transferred payload.

Separate from that chain: Edge Update, a OneDrive scheduled updater with DNS and an outbound HTTPS connection to 52.123.128.14, a BITS start-type toggle (demand to auto, then back to demand), a SYSTEM service logon, local-group enumeration by svchost.exe, SmartScreen, a scheduled taskhostw / SoftLandingTask pair, and Windows Update MoUsoCoreWorker.exe. None of these share process, parent, or command-line linkage with the T1059.003 activity.

Inference, not a logged fact: the path names and command lines are those of a controlled command-shell execution test in the isolated lab, not an uncontrolled intrusion. No network connection, persistence, credential access, or lateral movement is present for the execution chain. Confidence in the reconstructed sequence is high. Confidence that this is lab test activity rather than adversary tradecraft is medium-high, because that conclusion rests on the explicit path strings plus the stated lab context, not on a captured test-runner parent.

2. Scope of Activity

Item	Value
Host	DESKTOP-5OG7C28
Agent	001 / Windows_VM / 192.168.232.130
Manager	dcasey-virtual-machine
Window	2026-10-02 16:50:41–16:59:43 +0200 (UTC 14:50:41–14:59:43)
Archive events	31
Alerts	6
User on the execution chain	DESKTOP-5OG7C28\Darragh Casey
Integrity / logon / session	High / 0xA8D6D / terminal session 1

Channels present: Sysmon Operational (process create EID 1, process terminate EID 5, network EID 3, file create EID 11, DNS EID 22), System (Service Control Manager 7040), and Security (4624, 4672, 4799).

The export does not include the parent image for PID 4408, the contents or hash of T1059.003_script.bat, exit codes, or any network event from powershell.exe, cmd.exe, hostname.exe, or whoami.exe. Process-terminate is present only for the OneDrive updater.

3. Detailed Investigation

Execution chain (relevant)

Two bursts share user, integrity, logon ID, and parent PID 4408. Sysmon recorded ParentImage: - and a null parent ProcessGuid for those children, so the parent process is not identified in this export. The children are still tied together by parent PID, logon, and working directory.

Burst 1, UTC 14:52:59–14:53:00:

- HOSTNAME.EXE PID 2576, cwd C:\Users\Darragh Casey\Desktop\T1059.003\, record 15234.
- whoami.exe PID 8576, same cwd, record 15235.
- powershell.exe PID 7164, cwd C:\Users\DARRAG~1\AppData\Local\Temp\, command line powershell.exe & {if (Test-Path "C:\AtomicRedTeam\atomics\..\ExternalPayloads\T1059.003_script.bat") {exit 0} else {exit 1}}, record 15236.
- That PowerShell process created C:\Users\Darragh Casey\AppData\Local\Temp__PSScriptPolicyTest_jarjq0wa.5fg.ps1 (EID 11, record 15237). This is the event behind alert rule 92213, level 15, “Executable file dropped in folder commonly used by malware,” MITRE tag T1105.

Burst 2, UTC 14:55:25–14:55:27:

- Four further HOSTNAME.EXE creates from the same desktop folder (PIDs 10356, 10696, 10808, 1712; records 15240–15242 and 15246).
- Two further whoami.exe creates (PIDs 10384, 10400; records 15243, 15247).
- powershell.exe PID 4484 repeated the same Test-Path check (record 15244) and created __PSScriptPolicyTest_z4baxwgm.atc.ps1 (record 15245). Second rule 92213 alert.
- powershell.exe PID 1212 ran powershell.exe & {Start-Process "C:\AtomicRedTeam\atomics\..\ExternalPayloads\T1059.003_script.bat"} (record 15248) and created __PSScriptPolicyTest_sct5nwuc.3fq.ps1 (record 15249). Third rule 92213 alert.
- Child cmd.exe PID 8188, parent PID 1212, integrity High, command line C:\WINDOWS\system32\cmd.exe /c ""C:\AtomicRedTeam\ExternalPayloads\T1059.003_script.bat" ", cwd the user Temp folder (record 15251). This is alert rule 92004, level 4, “Powershell process spawned Windows command shell instance,” MITRE tag T1059.003.

cmd.exe hash in that event is the Windows binary: SHA256 97AC98B1A92C286054CCE55239CFCCDFC23A5517BD07FE693072C9CA96C7DABB. PowerShell hash SHA256 8BB6FA8C283B4D92120B1EF249A9B311B0F804D4CABBE9981159976C8BE76A5E. hostname.exe and whoami.exe hashes are stable across the repeats and match the in-box originals recorded in the same events.

Directly observed: a high-integrity user process tree checked for a batch file under C:\AtomicRedTeam\ExternalPayloads\, then PowerShell started that file through cmd.exe /c, while hostname and whoami ran from a desktop folder named T1059.003. Inferred: PID 4408 is the unseen runner for both bursts; the Test-Path then Start-Process pattern is a prerequisite check followed by execution; the repeated discovery binaries are part of the same action, not a separate intrusion. The batch file body is not in the telemetry, so what T1059.003_script.bat did after launch is not established.

Rule 92213 does not match the file-create evidence

All three EID 11 targets are __PSScriptPolicyTest_.ps1, created by C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe in the user Temp directory at the same second as a PowerShell start. That filename is the script-policy probe PowerShell writes when a new host starts. The rule description and T1105 tag treat any executable-looking create in Temp as ingress tool transfer. Here the created object is a policy test script, the image is Windows PowerShell, and there is no preceding download, no alternate extension, and no execution of

those .ps1 files. The alerts are retained as detection records, but they are not evidence of a dropped payload.

BITS and the surrounding Microsoft activity (not part of the chain)

- 14:50:40 — MicrosoftEdgeUpdate.exe /ua /installsource core, SYSTEM, parent the same binary with /c (record 15228).
- 14:51:13 — Task Scheduler svchost.exe -k netsvcs -p -s Schedule (PID 1268) started OneDriveStandaloneUpdater.exe /reporting as the user, medium integrity (record 15229).
- Same second — Security 4624 logon type 5 for NT AUTHORITY\SYSTEM by services.exe, plus 4672 assigning the standard SYSTEM privilege set, and System 7040: BITS start type changed from demand start to auto start (record 3018; rule 61104, level 3).
- 14:51:17 — 4799 enumeration of Builtin Administrators and Backup Operators by svchost.exe, subject the machine account, logon 0x3E7.
- 14:51:19 — DNS oneclient.sfx.ms from svchost (SYSTEM) and ecs.office.com from the OneDrive updater; updater TCP 443 to 52.123.128.14, which is an address in the ecs.office.com result set. Source 192.168.232.130:53640.
- 14:52:29 — OneDrive updater process terminate (EID 5, PID 9192).
- 14:53:18 — BITS start type changed from auto start back to demand start (record 3019; second rule 61104).
- 14:55:01 — taskhostw.exe from the Schedule service and SoftLandingTask.exe -Embedding.
- 14:55:27 — smartscreen.exe -Embedding, medium integrity, user context, parent PID 952 (image not captured). Timing matches the batch launch.
- 14:59:42 — MoUsocoreWorker.exe useprivatenamespaces, SYSTEM (record 15252).

Observed: BITS was flipped to auto and restored to demand within about two minutes, overlapping the OneDrive updater, not the later AtomicRedTeam command lines. No bitsadmin, no BITS job name, and no file transfer via BITS appear. The 4624/4672 pair is a service logon (type 5) for SYSTEM. The 4799 events are machine-account group reads, not user discovery. Inferred: BITS and the group reads are side effects of the updater/service activity. They are excluded from the incident chain because process, user integrity, and command line do not connect them to PID 4408 or the T1059.003 paths.

4. Evidence Analysis

Alert-to-event linkage:

Alert time (+0200)	Rule	Lvl	Underlying record	Assessment
16:51:14.642	61104 Service startup type changed	3	7040 / 3018, BITS demand to auto	Informational. Coincides with OneDrive updater and a type-5 SYSTEM logon. No BITS abuse evidence.
16:53:00.773	92213 Executable dropped in malware-common folder	15	EID 11 / 15237, __PSScriptPolicyTest_jarjq0wa.5fg.ps1 by PID 7164	False positive relative to the rule's T1105 claim. PowerShell policy-test file.
16:53:19.959	61104	3	7040 / 3019, BITS auto to demand	Reversal of the earlier change.
16:55:27.006	92213	15	EID 11 / 15245, __PSScriptPolicyTest_z4baxwgm.atc.ps1 by PID 4484	Same class of false positive.
16:55:27.928	92213	15	EID 11 / 15249, __PSScriptPolicyTest_sct5nwuc.3fq.ps1 by PID 1212	Same. Creating process is the Start-Process PowerShell.
16:55:27.929	92004 PowerShell spawned cmd	4	EID 1 / 15251, cmd PID 8188, parent PowerShell PID 1212	Supported. Command line is the batch path under C:\AtomicRedTeam\ExternalPayloads\.

Rule 61104 carries PCI, GDPR, HIPAA, NIST, and TSC tags in the alert object. Those are rule metadata, not evidence that any of those controls were violated.

The only network evidence is the OneDrive updater's outbound 443 to 52.123.128.14 after resolving ecs.office.com, plus DNS for oneclient.sfx.ms. That destination appears in the same DNS answer. It is not attributed to the execution chain.

Parent gap: every hostname, whoami, and the two PowerShell hosts list parentProcessId 4408 with ParentImage -. Only the cmd.exe create has a filled parent image, and that parent is PowerShell PID 1212. Correlation of the discovery commands to the batch launch is by shared parent PID, logon 0xA8D6D, user, high integrity, and the T1059.003 working directory, not by a captured parent command line.

5. Timeline of Events

Times are UTC (systemTime / Sysmon UtcTime). Add two hours for the Wazuh +0200 timestamps.

UTC	Event
14:50:40	Edge Update /ua /installsource core as SYSTEM. Unrelated.
14:51:13.330	Schedule service starts OneDriveStandaloneUpdater /reporting.
14:51:13.568	Type-5 SYSTEM logon by services.exe; special privileges assigned.
14:51:13.681	BITS start type demand to auto. Alert 61104.
14:51:17	svchost enumerates Administrators and Backup Operators.
14:51:19	DNS oneclient.sfx.ms, ecs.office.com; updater connects to 52.123.128.14:443.
14:52:29	OneDrive updater exits.
14:52:59.793	hostname.exe PID 2576 from Desktop\T1059.003, parent 4408.
14:52:59.820	whoami.exe PID 8576, same cwd, parent 4408.
14:53:00.058	PowerShell PID 7164 Test-Path of T1059.003_script.bat.
14:53:00.175	PID 7164 creates __PSScriptPolicyTest_jarjq0wa.5fg.ps1. Alert 92213.
14:53:18.994	BITS start type auto to demand. Alert 61104.
14:55:01	taskhostw / SoftLandingTask from Schedule. Unrelated.
14:55:25.945–26.060	Three hostname.exe (PIDs 10356, 10696, 10808), parent 4408.
14:55:26.091	whoami.exe PID 10384.
14:55:26.328	PowerShell PID 4484 repeats Test-Path.
14:55:26.443	PID 4484 creates __PSScriptPolicyTest_z4baxwgm.atc.ps1. Alert 92213.
14:55:26.679	hostname.exe PID 1712.
14:55:26.710	whoami.exe PID 10400.
14:55:26.958	PowerShell PID 1212 Start-Process of the batch file.
14:55:27.119	PID 1212 creates __PSScriptPolicyTest_sct5nwuc.3fq.ps1. Alert 92213.
14:55:27.343	smartscreen.exe -Embedding.
14:55:27.411	cmd.exe PID 8188 runs T1059.003_script.bat via /c, parent PowerShell 1212. Alert 92004.
14:59:42	MoUsoCoreWorker.exe as SYSTEM. Unrelated.

6. MITRE ATT&CK; Mapping

Mappings below are limited to what the command lines and process lineage support. Rule tags are not treated as proof.

- **T1059.001 Command and Scripting Interpreter: PowerShell (Execution).** Observed: three powershell.exe creates with explicit script-block command lines (Test-Path, then Start-Process) under the user at high integrity. Records 15236, 15244, 15248.
- **T1059.003 Command and Scripting Interpreter: Windows Command Shell (Execution).** Observed: PowerShell PID 1212 spawned cmd.exe /c against C:\AtomicRedTeam\ExternalPayloads\T1059.003_script.bat. Record 15251, rule 92004. The technique ID is also in the path and filename; that is a naming fact in the log, not an independent ATT&CK; conclusion.

- **T1059.003 also covers the batch file itself as a command script.** Observed only as the target of cmd /c and Start-Process. Contents not captured.
- **T1082 System Information Discovery and T1033 System Owner/User Discovery (Discovery).** Inferred from five hostname.exe and three whoami.exe creates in the same parent/logon/cwd cluster. Weaker than the execution mapping because parent command line is missing, so it is not proven they were launched by the batch file rather than by the unseen parent. No other discovery commands (ipconfig, net, systeminfo, nltest) are present.
- **T1105 Ingress Tool Transfer is not supported.** Rule 92213 applied it to the three __PSScriptPolicyTest_*.ps1 creates. The evidence shows PowerShell writing its policy-test script in Temp. No transfer tool, no remote source, no execution of those files.
- **T1569.002 Service Execution / BITS abuse is not supported.** Event 7040 is a start-type change that was reversed. No BITS job execution is logged.
- **T1518.001 Security Software Discovery is not supported** for SmartScreen. smartscreen.exe -Embedding is a COM activation consistent with a newly launched file, not a discovery command.

No evidence for persistence, privilege escalation beyond the already-high token, credential access, lateral movement, collection, or exfiltration.

7. Overall Investigation Conclusion

What the logs show is a short, high-integrity execution sequence by Darragh Casey on DESKTOP-5OG7C28: discovery binaries hostname and whoami from Desktop\T1059.003, a PowerShell existence check for C:\AtomicRedTeam\ExternalPayloads\T1059.003_script.bat, then PowerShell Start-Process of that file into cmd.exe /c. The three critical file-drop alerts are PowerShell script-policy test files and should be closed as false positives against T1105. The BITS alerts are a reversible start-type change adjacent to OneDrive/service activity and are not linked to the batch execution.

What is inferred: this is controlled lab execution of a command-shell test whose artefact names are already in the command line, with PID 4408 as the uncaptured parent. That inference fits the isolated-lab context and the explicit AtomicRedTeam / T1059.003 strings. It is not proven by a runner command line, and the batch file's behaviour after cmd /c is unknown.

Overall confidence: high on the sequence and on the false-positive assessment of rules 92213 and 61104; medium-high on the lab-test characterisation. Residual gap is the missing parent image for PID 4408 and the absence of the batch file contents.